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A closer look at Flock before College Station's contract renewal vote

DeFlock BCS says they found ahead

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A closer look at Flock before College Station's contract renewal vote

By [Lillian Kosh](#)



BRAZOS COUNTY, Texas (KBTX) - Thursday night, College Station City Council will decide whether to renew the city's contract with Flock Safety. Ahead of that vote, KBTX spent the past several days trying to get answers from every side of the debate over these cameras: Brazos County Sheriff's Office, Bryan police, College Station police, and the local group leading the pushback.

That group is DeFlock, who have spent months in College Station.

Brazos County's Sheriff's Office, College Station police, and Bryan police agreed to speak with KBTX, but provided only a brief overview.

Scale of the problem

Three local agencies operate Flock cameras. Brazos County's Sheriff's Office runs 10 cameras. Bryan Police operates 17. College Station's network is by far the largest, with 84 cameras.

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and Kody Fox, who lives in Bryan and

Bryan and College Station police interviewed. Bryan police also received a records request.

Brazos County's Sheriff's Office runs 10 cameras. Bryan Police operates 17. College Station's network is by far the largest, with 84 cameras.

Ivan Svrcek said he first learned about the security vulnerabilities in Flock's cameras and became concerned that "not enough people were paying attention to how powerful these cameras are." John Hamilton started tracking camera locations using the national DeFlock map before speaking at Bryan-College Station city council meetings in February. Kody Fox said he began digging in after Flock cameras started appearing outside his own workplace.

Do the cameras only capture vehicles?

Bryan and College Station police both describe their Flock systems as motion-activated, meaning the cameras are triggered by any movement, not just passing cars. Both departments say that despite this, officers can only search vehicle-related images.

College Station police told KBTX in a written statement:

"Our cameras are motion activated, similar to a home security system or doorbell camera that

COLLEGE STATION FLOCK TRANSPARENCY PORTAL

However, DeFlock o

“With these camera
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DeFlock says its re
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hilton said. “It
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search for things

According to DeFlock, that pattern of use appears throughout the entire window of records they reviewed, October 2025 through July 2026, not as an isolated instance.

Bryan Police told KBTX it briefly tested a similar freeform-search capability in 2025, described it as a short trial, and said the department no longer uses it.

The Bryan immigration search

Reviewing Bryan Police’s audit logs, DeFlock found a search from January 2026 logged as “immigration retention.”

All three local agencies — Brazos County, Bryan, and College Station publish Flock transparency portals that list immigration enforcement as a prohibited use of the technology.

“The department recently responded to questions from KBTX regarding an audit containing a reference to ‘Immigration Enforcement.’ The reference relates to the department’s investigative activity surrounding a January 27, 2026, protest at Villa Maria Road and South Texas Avenue. Prior to the protest, BPD identified and investigated a confirmed social media threat of violence connected to a known person. The threat was investigated by the department’s investigative resources to assess the threat’s credibility.”

Thousands

DeFlock’s review of all agencies outside the department.

“College Station has a College Station Police said. “However, our data with a majority

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Brazos County Sheriff Wayne Dicky, in his interview with KBTX last week, said similar numbers involving his department’s data can be misleading:

“If an organization searches a statewide search, every system that is connected counts that as a search, even though their data may not have been involved at all... it’s a little misleading that you see these big numbers of other agencies searching Brazos County data.”

The usage creep

DeFlock also raised a broader concern: that Flock’s technology and capabilities are expanding faster than local policy and oversight can keep up.

“The usage creep of the entire system has proven to be too fast for us to keep up with, too fast for policy to keep up with. Because most of the time, we’re doing the informing of what the new technology is because it just changes so fast. And that’s an issue because our policymakers cannot keep up with that,” Fox said.

BCS DeFlock pointed to Flock’s continued expansion into new products, including drones, vehicle-mounted readers, and the ability to route existing traffic cameras through Flock’s software, as evidence the technology keeps evolving beyond what was originally presented to city councils.

Oversight and

DeFlock BCS also
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starting quarterly

BRAZOS COUNTY SHERIFF’S OFFICE

Bryan first installed Flock cameras more than two years ago, in January 2024. Both departments say they have found no confirmed cases of misuse. College Station has not provided KBTX with details on its own audit process.

However, DeFlock BCS concerns extend beyond how local departments use the cameras to how secure the cameras themselves are. The group points to a November 2025 [white paper by cybersecurity researcher Jon “GainSec” Gaines](#), which detailed several vulnerabilities in Flock’s hardware.

DeFlock also pointed to a separate incident in December, in which security researchers found more than 70 Flock cameras nationally streaming live video to the open internet due to a misconfiguration issue.

“Anyone in the world could go to a camera’s IP address and see that camera live streaming with no password authentication at all,” Hamilton added.

Whats next

With College Station's vote looming, DeFlock says residents should understand what does — and doesn't — happen if the city walks away from its Flock contract.

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his department's case, both the cameras and any collected data belong to the county and would be removed if its contract ended.

[College Station City Council](#) votes tomorrow night on whether to renew its Flock Safety contract. Residents who wish to speak at the meeting must register before 1 p.m. Thursday. The meeting begins at 6 p.m. at College Station City Hall.

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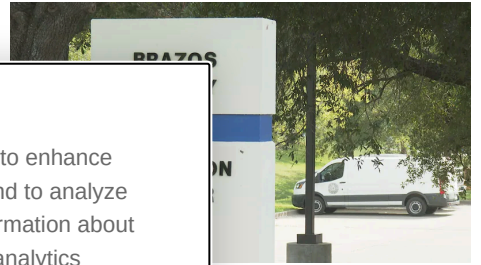
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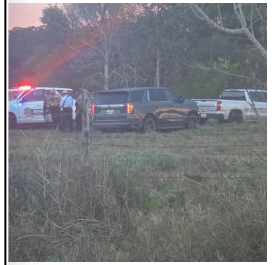
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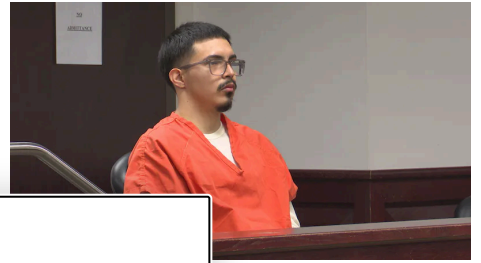
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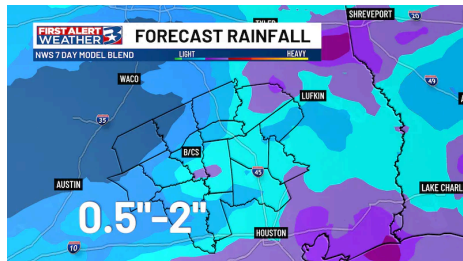
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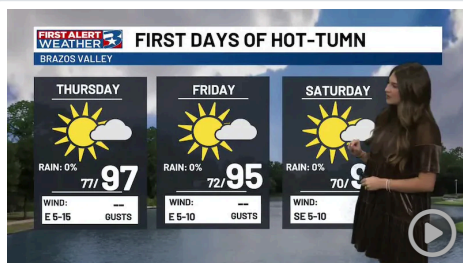
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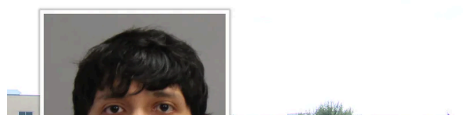
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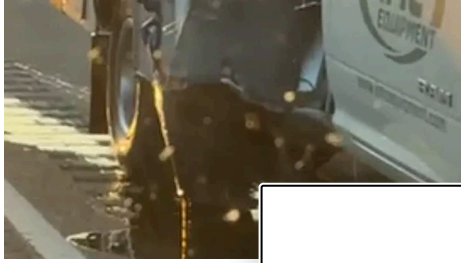
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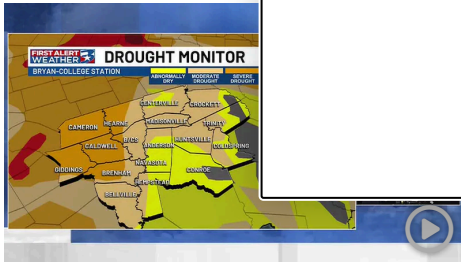
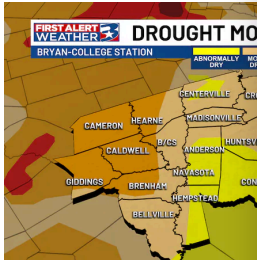
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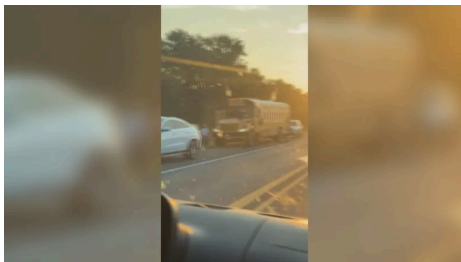


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